DealMatch

Stakeholder Analysis

This analysis identifies the people and organizations involved in, affected by, or supporting DealMatch. It focuses on the first-MVP scope and the roles needed to develop, operate, and use the platform.

1. Stakeholder Identification

Customers

Use DealMatch to discover, compare, save, and redeem relevant deals. They need easy navigation, useful category/subcategory recommendations, accurate deal information, and relevant nearby offers.

Merchants

Publish and manage offers, upload media, manage inventory, and monitor basic analytics and redemptions. They need a straightforward way to reach relevant customers and manage deals.

Administrators

Oversee platform activity, verify merchants and offers, monitor complaints, reviews, and refunds, and help maintain platform trust and safety.

Development Team

Design, build, integrate, test, and maintain the customer application, merchant dashboard, and supporting platform functionality.

Project Manager

Plans project activities, assigns responsibilities, monitors progress, coordinates stakeholders, and manages schedule and delivery risks.

Payment Service Provider

Supports payment processing when an external payment provider is used. Payment reliability and transaction-status information are important to purchase and commission workflows.

Hosting Provider

Provides infrastructure to host the platform, store and serve application data and media, and maintain availability.

2. Stakeholder Interests and Influence

Stakeholder	Main interest	Influence on project
Customers	Relevant deals, ease of use, accurate information, and convenient redemption.	High: adoption and feedback determine whether the platform provides value.
Merchants	Deal visibility, manageable commissions, inventory control, and useful performance information.	High: deal supply and merchant participation are essential to the marketplace.
Administrators	Platform control, verification, trust, complaint handling, and policy compliance.	High: administrative decisions affect platform quality and safety.
Development Team	Clear requirements, achievable tasks, technical support, and timely decisions.	High: responsible for delivering the system.
Project Manager	Meeting scope, schedule, coordination, and delivery objectives.	High: coordinates work and manages project progress.
Payment Service Provider	Reliable payment integration and accurate transaction processing.	Medium: important to payment workflows if an external provider is integrated.
Hosting Provider	Stable infrastructure, service availability, and technical support.	Medium: supports platform availability and performance.

3. Stakeholder Roles and Responsibilities

Customers

- Create accounts and select categories and subcategories.
- Browse, search, filter, save, and redeem deals.
- Provide feedback and report issues or inaccurate deal information.

Merchants

- Register and maintain accurate business information.
- Create and update deal listings and media.
- Maintain inventory and stock information.
- Review basic analytics and redemption records.

Administrators

- Review merchant and offer verification requests.
- Monitor platform activity and respond to complaints.
- Support reviews, ratings, refunds, and fraud-monitoring processes.

Development Team

- Implement the agreed MVP features.
- Maintain the application, database, and integrations.
- Perform technical testing and resolve defects.

Project Manager

- Prepare and maintain the project schedule.
- Coordinate tasks and stakeholder communication.
- Monitor risks, issues, and project deliverables.

Payment Service Provider

- Process payments when the selected solution requires an external provider.

• Return transaction status and reference information needed by the platform.

Hosting Provider

• Provide hosting infrastructure and service support.

• Support availability, backups, and operational reliability according to the selected service.

4. Stakeholder Communication Plan

Stakeholder	Information to communicate	Suggested method
Customers	New features, service updates, deal notifications, and feedback channels.	In-app notifications, help/contact channel, and feedback forms.
Merchants	Onboarding, deal requirements, verification status, inventory guidance, and updates.	Merchant dashboard notices, email, and support contact.
Administrators	Verification queues, reported issues, complaints, refunds, and platform activity.	Admin dashboard, internal meetings, and issue tracking.
Development Team	Requirements, task assignments, progress, defects, and technical decisions.	Project meetings, task board, and team communication channel.
Project Manager	Progress, schedule, risks, blockers, and completed deliverables.	Status meetings, project reports, and task tracking.
Payment Service Provider	Integration requirements, transaction failures, status updates, and technical issues.	Provider documentation, support channel, and technical correspondence.
Hosting Provider	Infrastructure requirements, outages, resource usage, and support requests.	Provider dashboard, service alerts, and support channel.

5. Stakeholder Engagement Approach

• **Involve customers:** Gather feedback during usability testing to check category/subcategory selection, deal discovery, and redemption.

• **Engage merchants early:** Validate deal creation, media upload, inventory, and basic analytics workflows before release.

• **Maintain administrative oversight:** Confirm verification, complaint, refund, and monitoring responsibilities before launch.

• **Coordinate the project team:** Review progress regularly, clarify requirements, and resolve blockers early.

• **Coordinate external providers:** Confirm technical requirements and support arrangements for payment and hosting services if used.

6. Conclusion

DealMatch depends on cooperation between customers, merchants, administrators, the project team, and supporting service providers. Customers and merchants are central to marketplace adoption, while administrators and the development team help ensure that the platform is reliable and trustworthy. Regular communication and early stakeholder involvement will help the project deliver an MVP that meets its intended goals.

Note: The exact payment and hosting providers have not been specified. They are included as supporting stakeholders because the platform may depend on these services.